

Afternoon Workshop:
Shape, Attract & Continue

SPOCs, Membership Officers, Communication Officers

UNITED GRAND LODGE OF ENGLAND

BUILDING TOGETHER

Attracting Members – Growing Freemasonry

SUPREME GRAND CHAPTER OF ROYAL ARCH MASONS OF ENGLAND

UNITED GRAND LODGE OF ENGLAND

BUILDING TOGETHER

Attracting Members – Growing Freemasonry

SUPREME GRAND CHAPTER OF ROYAL ARCH MASONS OF ENGLAND



BUILDING TOGETHER

Digital Quick start guide

V1 MAY 2025

THIS IS AN INTERACTIVE DOCUMENT, CLICK ON LINKS WITH THIS SYMBOL
OPEN ON A LAPTOP OR TABLET FOR OPTIMUM VIEWING

This contents page is interactive:
Click on the page you wish to read.

CONTENTS

4 Introducing Bulding Together

6 UGLE / SGC Strategy
9 The Membership Challenge
10 Who is Involved?
11 Why is Building Together important?
12 Introducing the Hub, Elements and Threads



SHAPE

Review & Plan

14 Reviewing your Unit
16 Creating a unit Outline
17 Creating a Development Plan
18 Succession Planning

Membership Action Plan

19 Preparing Your Message
20 Your Personal Statement
21 Identifying Potential New Members



ATTRACT

Attract Members

22 Promoting your Lodge
23 Engaging through social and community events
24 Explaining What Freemasonry Means to You
25 Expectation Management from the first point of contact

Interview Prospective Members

27 Managing Enquiries
28 Screening
29 Interview Process
31 Expectation Management



CONTINUE

Attracting Future Companions

32 Promoting your Chapter
34 All Companions are RA champions
35 RA reps
36 Where Prospective Companions Come From

Screening Prospective Companions

38 The right Chapter
39 Commitment

Expectation Management

40 Meetings/Festive Board
41 Regalia



ENGAGE

Support the New Member

42 Developing Understanding
43 Encouraging Participation
44 Planned Mentoring

Continued Support

45 Fostering fun, enjoyment and satisfaction
46 Guiding a member's learning
48 Supporting personal learning
49 Helping a member relocate
50 Continuing your journey

Re-engaging inactive members

51 Tracking attendance and apologies
52 Recognising signs of dissatisfaction
53 Engaging with absent members



RESPOND

Poor Engagement

54 Connecting with Unattached Members
55 Resignations & Next Steps
56 Lessons Learnt from Resignations
57 Recognising the need to review

Alternative Futures

58 Unit Options
59 Creating Efficiencies in a Unit

Introducing
BUILDING TOGETHER

BUILDING TOGETHER is the harmonisation of the **Members' Pathway** and **Archway** into one membership journey tool supporting Brethren and Companions work to grow their Lodges and Chapters. Within the material some **concepts have been introduced** which are different from material which you have seen before, some of these key changes are listed below:-

Key concepts

- When enquirers apply to join a Lodge, expectations are set that the Individual is joining FREEMASONRY and not just a Lodge. It comprises four ceremonies; three in a Craft Lodge and one in a Royal Arch Chapter, at a time and place of your choosing.
- Introduction of Mentors in the Royal Arch
- A Lodge Mentor and a Personal Mentor are the key people to help a Brother continue their journey to the Royal Arch
- All Companions are Champions of the Royal Arch
- The Building Together Model uses Five Hubs through which users navigate to resources, aspects relating to the Royal Arch are in all five Hubs. Attract and Continue focus on the journey from enquiry to joining (Member of Public to a Brother, and from a Brother to a Companion) and should be seen as mirroring each other as a process BUT using different vocabulary as the individual joining a Lodge will have little understanding of practices and traditions where as a Master Mason joining a Chapter will be able to understand and appreciate examples based on experiences from the Craft.
- Do not fall into the belief that Royal Arch material is only in Continue.

Vocabulary

As content was harmonised it became necessary to develop a collection of terms, many of which are collective nouns, to describe groups or processes. These are not for use in ritual or intended to be introduced constitutionally but save writing out multiple variations in Building Together which may differ slightly across the Craft and Royal Arch.

1. **Units** has been used as a collective noun when referring to Lodges and Chapters
2. **Provinces** has been used as a collective noun to include Provinces, Districts and the Metropolitan area
3. **Provincial Building Together Membership Group** (PBTMG) is the collective noun for Provincial Officers supporting local delivery of Building Together and helping Units
4. **Building Together Delivery Group** (BTDG) is UGLE & SGCs group who manage BUILDING TOGETHER

UGLE/SGC
STRATEGY



When faced with a document outlining the Strategy for the coming years, there is always a danger of regarding it as something of relevance only to UGLE/SGC – "*nothing to concern ordinary members*".

Actually, the opposite is true, since the Strategy will only succeed with the full involvement of all members.

This means we all need to have a ***clear and shared understanding of the direction we are going***, ensuring actions can contribute over time to a stronger, more secure future for our Lodges and Chapters.

We must now focus our energy on attracting new members (*not necessarily young!*) making sure that both new and established members find Freemasonry fun, enjoyable, satisfying and encouraging them to remain members for life. This way we will reverse the decline in numbers of recent years (*which some Provinces, have already started to address using the resources contained within the Members' Pathway and Archway that have now been harmonised into Building Together*) but we first need to understand why we have been losing more members than we have been gaining.

Both United Grand Lodge of England and Supreme Grand Chapter function in many areas as one organisation with a shared leadership and common values—the UGLE Strategy for Freemasonry is therefore an integrated one that reinforces the fundamental connection between the Royal Arch and the Craft.

Participation in the Royal Arch provides a new dimension to our members' experience and a more complete understanding of what it means to be a Freemason in the United Grand Lodge of England. It is an established fact that those who progress into the Royal Arch are far more likely to remain engaged with Freemasonry in general than those who limit their experience of what Pure Antient Masonry has to offer.

The success of the Royal Arch is therefore directly related to the success of our Lodges. A clear and shared understanding of this will ensure that our actions can contribute over time to a stronger, more secure future for Freemasonry in the 21st Century and beyond.

Our Lodges
Our Chapters
Our Future

BUILDING TOGETHER

Attracting Members – Growing Freemasonry

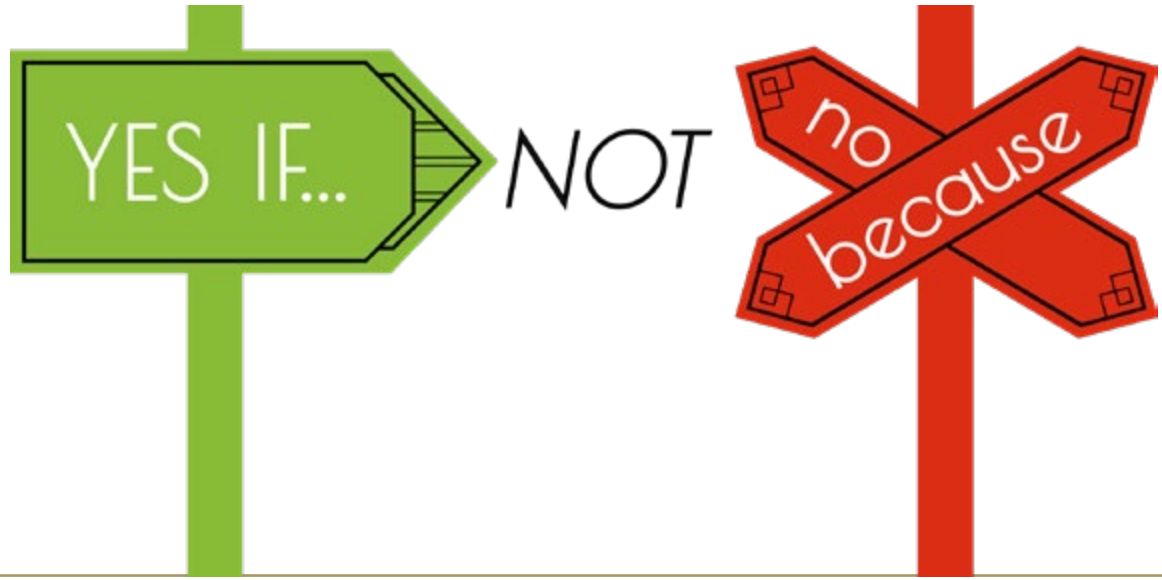
The practical advice offered in **BUILDING TOGETHER** directly addresses the main challenges our Units face. But to achieve the desired results, many Units need to be prepared to make changes where necessary—to try something new—or to stop doing something if it isn't working for your Unit.

We are rightly proud of our traditions, but as the years pass, these 'traditions' often accumulate, and some become outdated or unhelpful.

A key aspect to success of the Strategy is adoption of a different mindset— a **YES IF...** approach, not **No Because.**

When something new is proposed, be prepared to say **YES** we can achieve these goals **IF** we change this or that, rather than say no because we have always done it 'our way'.

You will then be able to face the future with renewed enthusiasm and measure your success in terms of increased member satisfaction and a return to a more secure future.



THE MEMBERSHIP CHALLENGE

In recent years Freemasonry has unfortunately been losing more members than it has been gaining and **The Membership Challenge**, which every Unit is asked to address, is essentially to reverse that trend. It is an intrinsic part of the Strategy for 2022 and beyond.

Although you might see figures referring to the size of the Challenge at UGLE / SGC level, or Provincial level, it is your individual Unit figures which are the most relevant to define what actions will be needed at Unit level.

Your Unit records or even Provincial records can provide the membership statistics for the previous 5+ years, which will show how many members have been lost and how many new members have joined – whether the trend is positive or negative.

When considering how to close the gap between gains and losses, the most reasonable and practical approach would be to increase the gains and at the same time reduce the losses.

This will require determined effort over time, involving all members, arranging events to attract new members, finding ways to involve every member in the life of the Unit to increase their sense of belonging, interest and commitment, and being alert to the early signs of poor attendance or late payment of dues, ready to step in to offer support and encouragement as appropriate.



Who is INVOLVED?

Introducing the Unit Membership Team

Using the Building Together successfully relies on the **Unit Membership Team** (Membership Officer, Mentor, and Almoner, amongst others) and the support your members give them.

All units are encouraged to find someone to take on each role, even if, due to availability, it has to be combined with another. Every member of the Unit, from the newest to the most experienced, should have the opportunity to contribute to Unit and Membership Development. A willingness to embrace change as part of inspiring and motivating Unit members will be a pre-requisite for success.

Building Together recognises individual Provinces and Units have created different structures to support members at various stages of their journey; it is flexible and not prescriptive.

The Provincial Building Together Membership Groups are also available to guide and support Units.



Why is BUILDING TOGETHER IMPORTANT?

- BUILDING TOGETHER contains practical ideas drawn from the experience and successes of Units over recent years in engaging members, ensuring meetings are well planned and enjoyed by all, stemming losses and growing memberships.

- It should be the catalyst to help re-build our Units and re-engage our membership capitalising on the great PR Freemasonry has received because of the incredible community support provided, for example, during the Covid crisis.

- It will allow us to showcase all that is great about Freemasonry, demonstrating how we champion our values of **Integrity, Respect, Friendship and Service.**

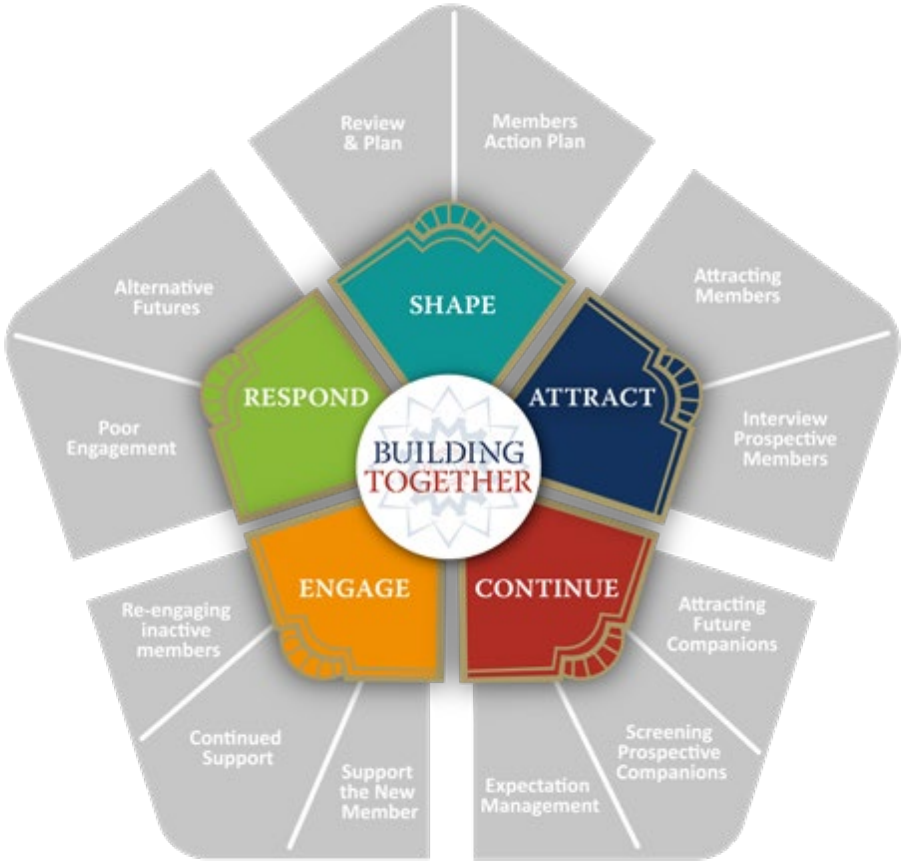
It will also help to answer questions such as:

- Who might be interested in Freemasonry?
- How do we present Freemasonry to prospective members?
- How do we support new and existing members?
- How do we make meetings enjoyable and appealing so that expectations are met and members get involved?

Introducing
THE HUB, ELEMENTS AND THREADS

BUILDING TOGETHER has been developed to direct the member with ease to the support materials they need.

It is presented as a pentagon illustrating the continuing cycle of review, plan and do that evolving and improving Units go through. The aim is to help create stronger, more vibrant Units, with happy members who demonstrably enjoy their Freemasonry.



THE HUB

The Hub is the starting point when using **BUILDING TOGETHER**, the five sections of the hub are shown here. **SHAPE**, **ENGAGE** and **RESPOND** contain material which relates to both the Craft and the Royal Arch. **ATTRACT** and **CONTINUE** focus on the journey from enquiry to joining (*Member of Public to a Brother, and from a Brother to a Companion*) and should be seen as mirroring each other as a process **BUT** using different vocabulary as the individual joining a Lodge will have little understanding of practices and traditions where as a Master Mason joining a Chapter will be able to understand and appreciate examples based on experiences from the Craft.

THE ELEMENTS



Each Hub section expands to Elements, where major topics are introduced which relate to areas of Unit activity.

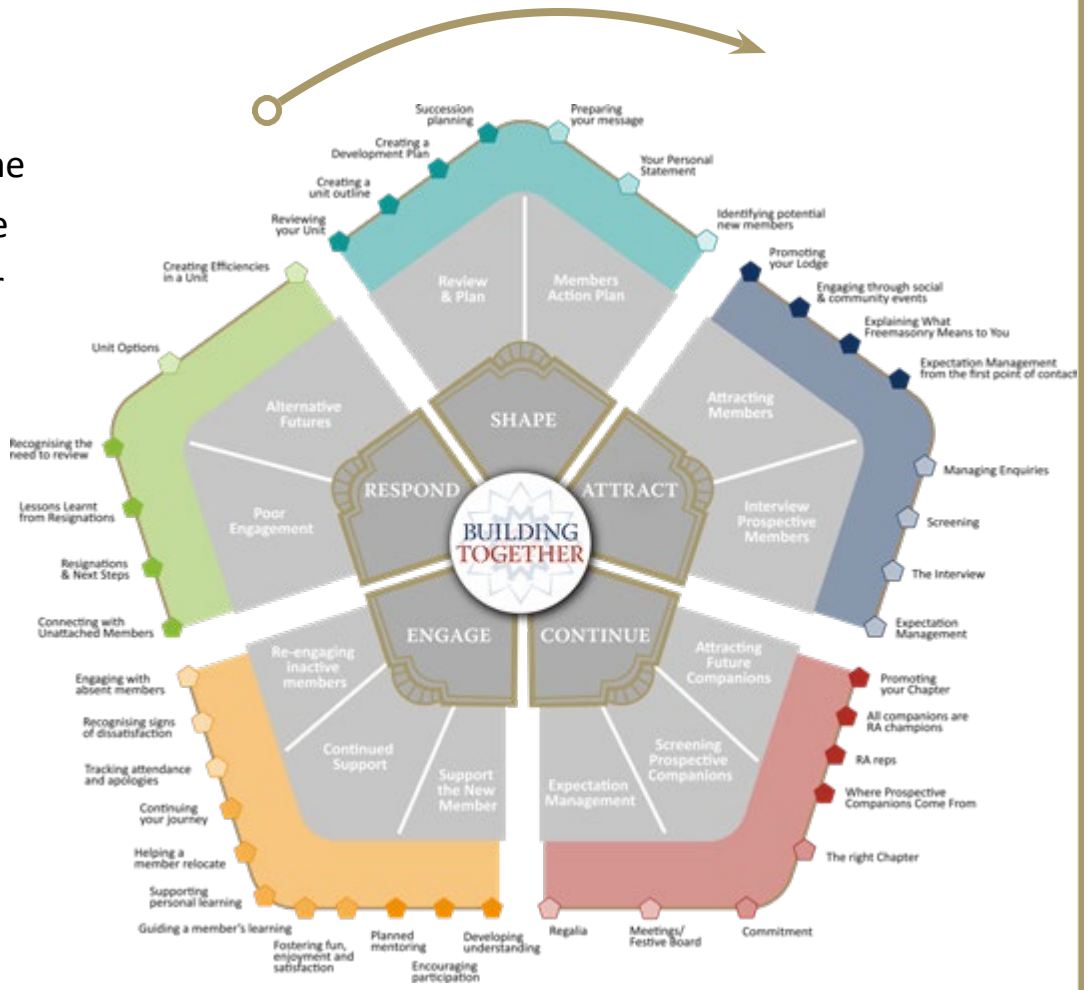
THE THREADS

Finally extending from the Elements are the Threads. The forty threads break down the Elements into subtopics. Building Together has been designed so the content of the Threads is available online, through

solomon.ugle.org.uk

This guide has a short summary of each Thread. These are presented visually working clockwise. Remember work from **HUB > ELEMENT > THREAD** to find the materials you want.

This Interactive PDF version includes links to detailed web-based guidance, linking between resources to help you navigate between the threads.



A quick start guide to BUILDING TOGETHER



SHAPE

- **Review and Plan**
- Reviewing your unit

The first stage in any plan is a review of your current situation, to identify issues that need attention, and which should be built into a plan. This applies to membership Units in Freemasonry (ie, Lodges and Chapters) as much as anything else. Throughout "BUILDING TOGETHER" we refer to **Lodges and Chapters** as "**Units**."

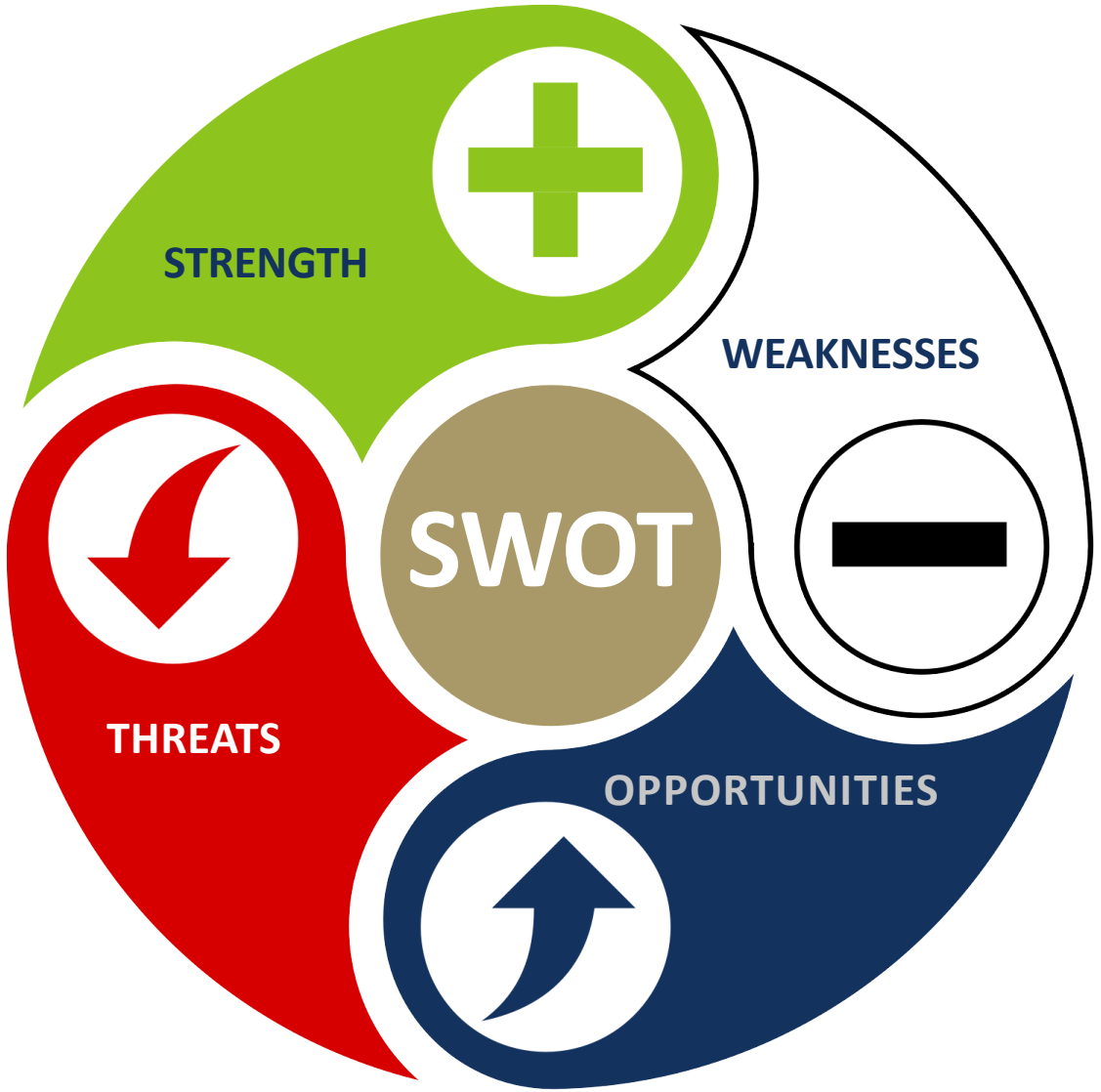
"**Reviewing your Unit**", describes how a Lodge or Chapter can "take stock" and review their current situation, consider whether it is attractive to likely members and lay the foundation for a plan to shape the future. We recommend that every Unit return to this process at regular intervals, whether it is successful or is struggling.



Once a Lodge Outline has been developed, you are able to start considering the Lodge's **strengths**, **weaknesses**, **opportunities** and **threats.**

List everything relevant to each area and then look to agree specific actions to enhance/promote the strengths and opportunities, reduce or remove the weaknesses and threats.

Thread link: Reviewing Your Unit



CLICK PDF icon to download the support material

- Time Cost Commitments
- Values Questionnaire
- Example Questions for Reviewing Your Unit
- Culture and Practices
- The Membership Challenge



SHAPE

Review and Plan

Creating a Unit Outline

What are we? captures the results of a Unit review in a Unit Outline.
A **Unit Outline** is an honest self-assessment of your Unit at a particular point in time. It describes the Unit's key features and especially its characteristics, circumstances, expectations and values. It should answer all the questions a person interested in membership might ask.

The Unit Outline is not intended to act as a brochure or any other form of promotional material. It is written for members, an internal audience, using the language of Freemasonry.

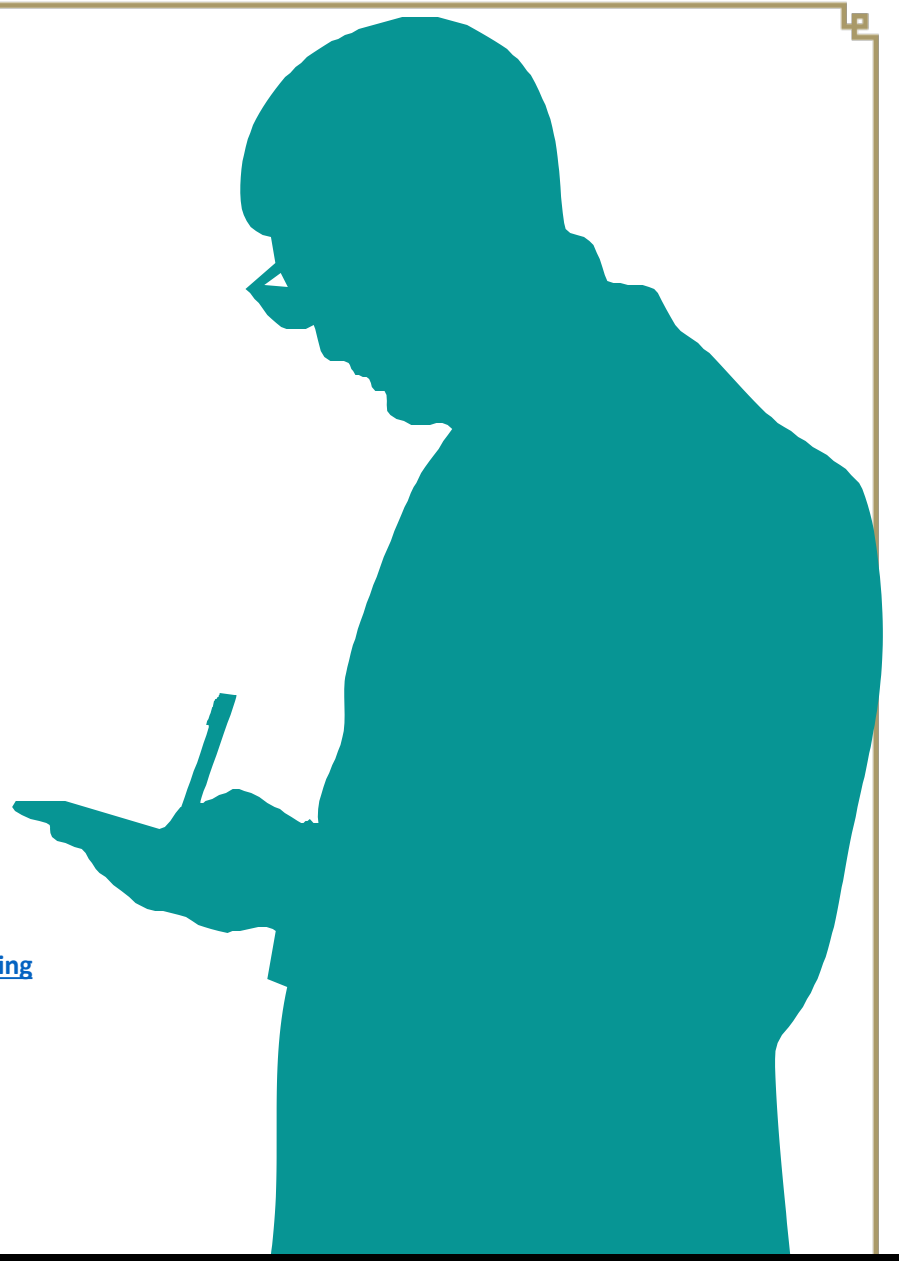
However, it is the basis for developing all promotional materials, such as a Lodge or Chapter Information Sheet, which are aimed at those who are not members.

Thread Link: Creating a Unit Outline

CLICK PDF icon to download the support material

PDF Techniques for Profiling Candidates

PDF Motives for Joining Freemasonry





SHAPE

Review and Plan

Creating a Development Plan

Creating a Development Plan, describes how to bring together members of your Lodge or Chapter to plan how you will develop over the next few years. The plan will ensure that the outcomes of your review are turned into positive actions over an agreed period of time.

1. Create a forum for discussion about the future of the Lodge or Chapter that is open to all members and not just the members of the Committee or the Past Masters / First Principals. This could be by inviting all members to planning meetings or by opening out some committee meetings to all members.
2. Start by reviewing the Lodge or Chapter as it is now. Include a SWOT analysis examining the unit's Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities and Threats.
3. Involve all members in the review and discussions.
4. Ask every member
    a) What they like about the Lodge or Chapter and what they wish to see continue?
    b) What they don't like about the Lodge or Chapter and what they wish to stop?
    c) What they would like to see introduced?
    d) Think of these in turn as Green, Red and Amber actions.

Follow the process detailed in the Thread to establish a plan to deliver positive outcomes over an agreed period of time.

Thread Link: Creating a Development Plan



SHAPE

Review and Plan

Succession Planning

A succession plan is used to plan for the rotation and succession of available people into key roles. In a Unit, it is used to identify members who are interested in certain offices and to ensure that the Unit does not become over dependent on a few members.

This thread includes guidance for building your unit's succession plan and a template for doing so.

It is as important to plan the succession through both progressive and non-progressive offices as it is to plan ceremonies. This allows for the preparation and training of new Officers, so that there is a smooth transition and handover to Brethren & Companions taking on new roles, and also highlights where members are potentially in a role for too long.

A simple spreadsheet can be created that identifies all of the Offices within the Unit and planned ceremonies for the forthcoming year and beyond, which will enable each Officer to be able to plan ahead (rather than, as all too often happens, trying to sort out Officers on the night).

Thread Link: Succession Planning

CLICK PDF icon to download the support material

Membership Teams



SHAPE

Membership Action Plan

Preparing Your Message

Once you have agreed your Lodge or Chapter's plan for development, the next stage is to prepare members to engage with those who are not members.

Having a prepared message will help members respond with confidence to questions from those who might be interested.

A Unit information sheet provides the main information a prospective member may ask in a format that will be useful to them and assist you, the member, in being able to explain about the Unit.

Key points about Unit Information Sheets:

- You can use the **Unit Outline**, which will have been completed at an earlier stage in the planning process, as the basis for writing a **Unit Information Sheet**.
- The **Unit Outline** is an honest self-assessment intended for internal use,
- An **Information Sheet** is written for those who are not members and is used to promote the Lodge or Chapter.
- It should be written in a language the audience understands, not the language of the ritual.
- *Lodge Information Sheets should be written in everyday language*. **Chapter Information Sheets can be written for Craft Freemasons.**

Additional Resources

- The booklet, "***Discover Freemasonry***", uses everyday language to describe Freemasonry.
- The booklet, "***Discover More***", uses language aimed at Craft Masons.

Thread Link: Preparing Your Message

CLICK PDF icon to download the support material

PDF Statements by the BoGP

PDF Charge after Initiation



SHAPE

Membership Action Plan

Your Personal Statement

If you are likely to be discussing Freemasonry with people who are not Freemasons, or the Royal Arch with Craft Masons, it is important to be in a positive frame of mind, proud of your membership, honest and clear about what membership means to you.

It helps to consider these issues in advance, to clarify your own thinking about the subject. Some people may choose to develop a series of phrases that they use, for others they may just use our Values of Integrity, Friendship, Respect and Service as talking points.

This thread will help you prepare a succinct "**personal statement**" to address questions such as, "*What is Freemasonry?*" or "*Why are you a Freemason?*" or "*Why should I join the Royal Arch?*" In the **Attract Hub** we expand this with "**Explaining to others what membership means to you**", offers guidance how to use this when speaking with those who are not Freemasons.

Thread Link: Your Personal Statement





SHAPE

Membership Action Plan

Identifying Potential New Members

The traditional route for new members to join Freemasonry is through long standing friends, family members and colleagues. The personal recommendation of a candidate by an existing member is recognised and respected by the other brethren. Candidates who come through this route are often referred to as sponsored candidates, this is known as a **Direct Enquiry as they have made an enquiry to a Freemason that they know**.

In the case of the Royal Arch, potential new members are already Craft Freemasons and may already be known to existing Companions.

The growth of the internet and social media, coupled with UGLE's increased openness, have introduced other routes into membership for people attracted to what Freemasonry can offer but who do not know a Freemason themselves often referred to as an **Independent Enquiry (as they have made contact independently of knowing a freemason)**. UGLE and its Provinces now run a sophisticated system to receive, screen and allocate enquirers to Lodges that are best suited to them.

The future health and strength of your Lodge, and ultimately your Chapter, will benefit from you understanding the balance between these two routes and why and how people seek to join a membership organisation. The following data, from both outside and inside Freemasonry, explains these points and lead to an approach that will help you identify future members.

Thread Link: Identifying Potential New Members

CLICK PDF icon to download the support material

PDF Positive Public Image





ATTRACT

Attracting Members

Promoting Your Lodge

If you want to attract new members to your Lodge, your message must have something that is attractive and appealing. The responsibility for making this happen is shared across all members.

Lodges whose members are able and willing to engage with others will be more successful at attracting new members. We cannot expect others to do this for us.

If you have followed the guidance in the Shape Hub Elements of Building Together, all your members will have identified what this is for your Lodge.

We know that far more people get their news through local and social media than the national press. So, these channels are the most appropriate to make your Lodge or Chapter visible and communicate what it offers.



The detail of this thread gives you points to reflect and consider before looking to reach out to **PERSONAL CONTACTS** or **ENGAGE WITH PEOPLE THROUGH SOCIAL MEDIA**.

Thread Link: Promoting Your Lodge or Chapter



ATTRACT

Attracting Members

Engaging through Social and Community Events



Lodges with a strong social element and which are engaged in and have visibility in supporting community based events and projects are generally more successful at attracting new members.

Each of us knows a large number of people from various facets of our lives, including family, friends, work colleagues, members of other organisations we belong to. Many may have some curiosity about Freemasonry and creating an opportunity for them and their wives and partners to meet us socially is a fantastic opportunity for us to introduce them in a low-key way to who and what we are – and may lead to them wishing to join.

Lodges engaging in community/charity events have an incredible opportunity to promote what Freemasonry stands for, while also raising awareness of the local Lodge and its members.

The full thread looks at different type of **SOCIAL EVENTS** from **WHITE TABLES**, **COMMUNITY EVENTS** and highlights points for consideration which a Lodge Membership Team may wish to consider.

Thread Link: Engaging through Social and Community Events



ATTRACT

Attracting Members

- Explaining to others what Freemasonry means to you

Freemasonry means many different things to each of us, **but there is a common thread through our key values of Integrity, Friendship, Respect** and **Service.**

When explaining what Freemasonry means to you, it is helpful to use your own words and not overcomplicate it with the vocabulary used in Lodge.

Your thoughts should be personal to you in answering any questions. Be honest, anticipate the difficult questions and be in a position to respond to them positively and without being defensive, using everyday language.

There are numerous leaflets and online documents that you can provide to the inquiring individual.

If you need help explaining what it means, look at the UGLE website or your Metropolitan, Provincial or District Grand Lodge website.

Areas you may wish to consider are reviewed in greater detail in the full thread which you can access below:-

Thread Link:
Explaining to others what Freemasonry means to you



INTEGRITY | FRIENDSHIP | RESPECT | SERVICE

UNITED GRAND LODGE OF ENGLAND
BRAND BOOK



UNITED GRAND LODGE
OF ENGLAND

2024

WELCOME TO OUR UNITED GRAND LODGE OF ENGLAND BRAND BOOK

Our United Grand Lodge of England (UGLE) brand represents us in every interaction, whether it be through public engagements, presentations to diverse audiences, or what we stand for.

The branding reflects the new spirit of openness, projecting Freemasonry as modern and relevant to society today. Aligned with our overarching mission to foster a positive reputation for Freemasonry in today's society, the new messaging is a strategic step toward ensuring its enduring legacy.

To strengthen our brand presence and foster trust among our members, potential candidates, and the public, it is crucial to raise awareness about UGLE. The more individuals who connect with and support our mission, the closer we come to achieving our goals.

UNITED GRAND LODGE OF ENGLAND

WHAT IS THE UGLE BRAND BOOK?

A consistent brand: Our Brand Book is an internal guide that presents what we say (our positioning), what we look like (our visuals), how we say it (our voice) and why (our values and behaviours).

WHO IS THE BRAND BOOK FOR?

A guide for everyone: Our Brand Book is a set of guiding principles that offer direction and inspiration to our UGLE team, as well as Provincial and District teams, for all internal and external communications.

WHY IS THE BRAND BOOK IMPORTANT?

A stronger brand: Understanding and applying our brand values, visuals and positioning ensures that we consistently present a unified image for Freemasonry.



Download the most up-to date copy of the UGLE Brand Book from the UGLE Brand Centre

1.1

OUR MISSION

We are a unique members' organisation that has thrived for over 300 years. Having no political or religious affiliations, we comprise members of all ages, races, religions, cultures and backgrounds.

We meet in our individual Lodges throughout the country where we have ceremonial traditions which encourage us both to be more tolerant and respectful and actively to fulfil our civic and charitable responsibilities; we also make time to eat, drink and meet together, and form lifelong friendships.

UNITED GRAND LODGE OF ENGLAND



3.1

OUR CORE VALUES

Our core values are the underlying principles behind who we are, what we stand for, and what we do. They are vital to understanding Freemasonry.

Our core values they should always be presented in the following order:

1. INTEGRITY
2. FRIENDSHIP
3. RESPECT
4. SERVICE

UNITED GRAND LODGE OF ENGLAND

INTEGRITY

Honesty, trustworthiness, honour, reliability, and conscientiousness form the foundation of a virtuous character. They foster trust, maintain integrity, and demonstrate commitment, ultimately leading to a life of strong principles and dependable actions.

FRIENDSHIP

Freemasonry gives members many opportunities to make a wide circle of friends for life who share common interests and values.

It provides a bond of friendship and a sense of belonging. This promotes a feeling of enjoyment and fulfilment.

RESPECT

From its earliest days, Freemasonry has respected the beliefs of its members. It promotes an environment where diversity is valued. It is a space where different beliefs and backgrounds converge, fostering an atmosphere of inclusivity, tolerance and harmony.

SERVICE

Whether participating in events, fundraising for a charitable cause or volunteering for public or community organisations, service is at the very heart of Freemasonry. Our members make valuable contributions by donating time, resources and skills.

3.1

OUR CORE VALUES

An overview of the new UGLE narrative with an anatomy of the new tag line and statement.

UNITED GRAND LODGE OF ENGLAND

UNITED GRAND LODGE OF ENGLAND | BUILDING TOGETHER

→ Tag Line

Building friendships, supporting communities and enabling personal growth through timeless tradition.

→ Compelling Statement

Freemasonry offers the opportunity to engage with like-minded people from different backgrounds who you wouldn't usually meet.

Freemasons actively engage in charitable events and activities. They dedicate time, resources and skills to support communities by being part of something that makes a difference to the world.

It provides an opportunity to explore your potential through improved self-knowledge and confidence on an enduring foundation of ethical and moral values.

Those values, upheld by its members, offer a framework for making better choices in life and living a more fulfilling and purposeful existence.

4.1

TONE OF VOICE

Our brand identity is also built around our tone of voice. It's not only about the words we choose – it's equally about how we express ourselves and what people take away from all our communication channels.

Our tone of voice is a direct reflection of our brand personality, values and behaviours. It's a significant aspect of who we are as an organisation.

Adopting a consistent Tone of Voice (TOV) across the company and through every channel is a way of strengthening our brand and effectively communicating what United Grand Lodge of England is all about.

UNITED GRAND LODGE OF ENGLAND

TONE OF VOICE

When we communicate we are **transparent**, **personal** and **positive**, defining our commitment to highlighting our **contributions** in alignment with our core principles.

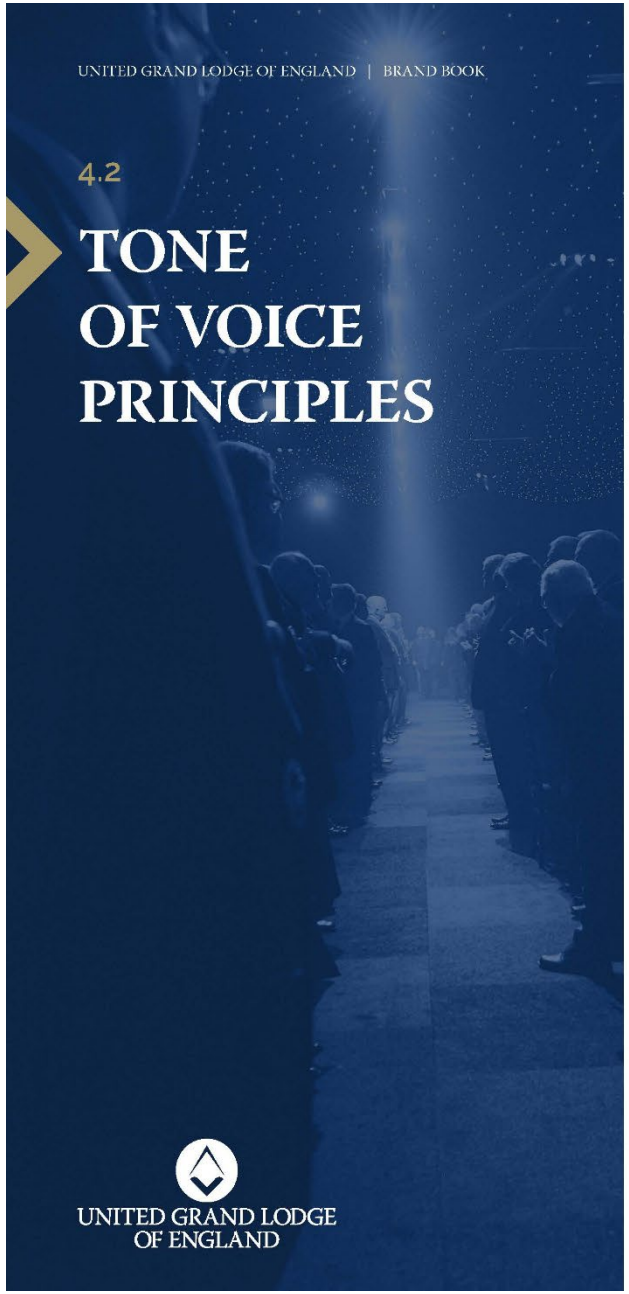
We believe in simplicity - expressing ourselves concisely and clearly, using plain language that resonates with all our diverse audiences.

Our communication is **personal**, reflecting our **genuine care** for our members and the communities in which we live.

We are dedicated to showcasing the **positive** connotations and contributions of our organisation through clear, accessible, and transparent communication.

We strive to make sure that when we communicate, we do so in a way that shows that Freemasonry is an enjoyable and fun experience – reflecting our relevancy to all sections of society.

NOTE!
Download Tone of Voice examples from the UGLE Brand Centre



We highlight our contributions by always communicating in a transparent, positive and personal manner.

What this means: We express ourselves in a clear and concise manner, making sure our messages are easily comprehensible. Our tone is more than just delivering information; it is also about being approachable and helpful, building a meaningful connection with our audience.

Writing sample 1

"Freemasonry offers the opportunity to engage with like-minded people from different backgrounds."

Be straightforward:

Use simple, clear words to convey our message. Use a conversational, natural language that's easy to follow.

Explain what the organisation has to offer with honesty and in a concise manner, avoiding overcommitting or making promises.

Writing sample 2

"Our members play a crucial role at local, national, and global levels each year, dedicating both their time and resources to make a tangible difference."

Be personal:

Use phrases like 'Our members' to establish a sense of belonging and a direct connection with the audience.

Recognise the individual efforts of members creating a communication style that is respectful and appreciative.

Writing sample 3

"One of the oldest social and charitable organisations in the world, Freemasonry's roots lie in the traditions of the medieval stonemasons who built our cathedrals and castles."

Be clear:

Centre on expressing our identity without discussing what we aren't, steering clear of reinforcing common misconceptions.

4.3

PUTTING IT ALL TOGETHER

In crafting or evaluating our written and presentation content, we integrate the principles of tone of voice to ensure we leave our audiences:

- With a clear understanding of who we are and what we do
- Assured that our members and communities are valued
- Confident in the inclusivity and enjoyability of our organisation
- We never repeat negative sentences about Freemasonry – instead focus on being positive.

UNITED GRAND LODGE OF ENGLAND

BEFORE

We used abbreviations like **ProvGM, PPGSwdB.**

We used titles for ranks like **W.Bro** or **V.W.Bro**.

We used terms like **temples** and **rituals**.

We used phrases like ***"We are not a secret society".***

AFTER

We spell out abbreviations and opt for terms like **Provincial Grand Master/Head of …. Freemasons** or tailor our language to the context.

We avoid the use of jargon that would not resonate with the wider audience.

We favour expressions like **lodge rooms/meeting rooms** and **ceremonies/meetings**.

We present ourselves using phrases like ***"unique and diverse members' organisation"***.

WHY?

Our goal is to guarantee that our message resonates with a diverse audience, promoting inclusivity and transparent communication.

We choose positively connoted words that are easily accessible to a broad public.

Rather than stating what we are not, facing the risk of perpetuating misconceptions, we emphasise clear communication of our identity, the positive impact we create, and the enriching experience of our membership.

5.1

OUR AUDIENCES

- External audiences
- The Media
- Potential members
- Subscribing members
- Unattached members
- Paid staff in Masonic buildings (UGLE, Provinces and Halls)
- Masonic Families

UNITED GRAND LODGE OF ENGLAND

EXTERNAL AUDIENCES

Who are they?

External audiences are non-Freemasons who know little or nothing about Freemasonry.

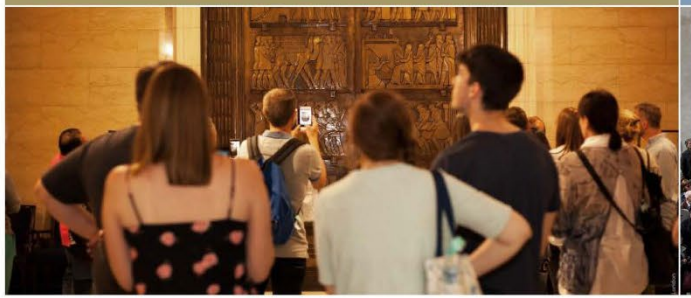
What do they care about?

- They want to know more about the organisation and may have an existing, negative perception
- They are likely to want to know about 'secrecy' and other commonly held misconceptions
- It is likely that they have little or no understanding of what Freemasonry is.

SO!

We must demonstrate:

- That we are an open and diverse organisation with a fascinating history and tangible benefits for members
- That many misconceptions are inaccurate and misrepresent what Freemasonry is
- Share information and news in a clear and concise way – with an intention to inform those that are unaware.





5.2

OUR AUDIENCES

External audiences
The Media
Potential members
Subscribing members
Unattached members
Paid staff in Masonic buildings (UGLE, Provinces and Halls)
Masonic Families

UNITED GRAND LODGE OF ENGLAND

THE MEDIA

Who are they?

The media are both digital and print publications and have both a national and local presence. Certain publications have been sceptical about Freemasonry in the past and it is important that we address these concerns through positive stories.

What do they care about?

- It is likely that they are looking for an angle for a story
- They are looking for engaging text without jargon or confusing language
- They are looking for good images to accompany the story
- They are looking for potential for an extended piece.

SO!

We must demonstrate:

- That we are an open and diverse organisation that is willing to engage and talk to the press
- We need to make sure that our press releases are interesting, informative and engaging
- We need to make sure that we are providing the press with high quality images that clearly demonstrate the core of the story
- That we are ready to engage further and are happy to do so.





5.3

OUR AUDIENCES

External audiences
The Media
Potential members
Subscribing members
Unattached members
Paid staff in Masonic buildings (UGLE, Provinces and Halls)
Masonic Families

UNITED GRAND LODGE OF ENGLAND

POTENTIAL MEMBERS

Who are they?

These are people that have shown an interest in joining the organisation – either as sponsored or unsponsored candidates. They should have some form of pre-existing knowledge about Freemasonry. We strongly advise that any promotional activities planned by a Lodge should be checked with the Provincial or Metropolitan Communications Team.

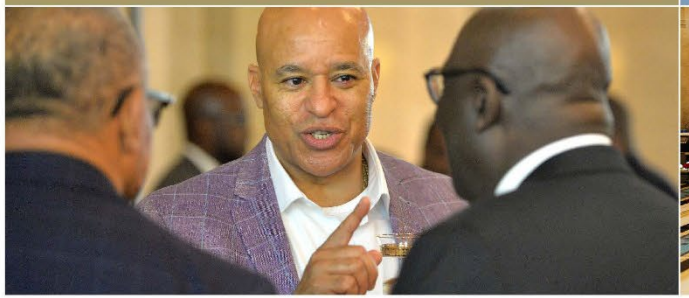
What do they care about?

- Finding out more about Freemasonry and whether UGLE is an organisation of potential interest to them
- They have other interests and hobbies and may be attracted by the prospect of joining a Special Interest Lodge.

SO!

We must demonstrate:

- A willingness to talk openly about Freemasonry and what membership of UGLE could mean for them
- How Freemasonry brings together like-minded people – particularly in the case of the various Special Interest Lodges that are available
- How generations of families have been intrinsically linked by Freemasonry throughout the history of the organisation.





5.4

OUR AUDIENCES

External audiences
The Media
Potential members
Subscribing members
Unattached members
Paid staff in Masonic buildings (UGLE, Provinces and Halls)
Masonic Families

UNITED GRAND LODGE OF ENGLAND

SUBSCRIBING MEMBERS

Who are they?

There are current members of Lodges under the United Grand Lodge of England.

What do they care about?

- They are often proud of their membership of Freemasonry, but may be careful of who they tell that they are a Freemason
- They want to hear about developments within Freemasonry
- They are interested in helping to spread the word about Freemasonry for positive reasons.

SO!

We must demonstrate:

- That we have a convincing and engaging narrative that can be shared by them when talking about their membership of Freemasonry
- That we can effectively communicate to members with key developments and updates from UGLE
- That we can provide members with the tools that they need to become ambassadors for Freemasonry.





5.5

OUR AUDIENCES

External audiences
The Media
Potential members
Subscribing members
Unattached members
Paid staff in Masonic buildings (UGLE, Provinces and Halls)
Masonic Families

UNITED GRAND LODGE OF ENGLAND

UNATTACHED MEMBERS

Who are they?

These are Freemasons that have resigned from their Lodge but are still Freemasons who are able to join other Lodges, so long as they are in good standing with their former Lodges.

What do they care about?

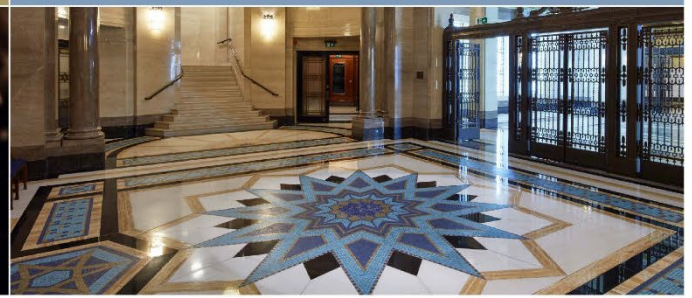
- Their individual reasons for leaving – this could include finances, work commitments, arguments within their Lodges or re-location – plus many more.

SO!

We must demonstrate:

- That as an organisation, we are compassionate and understanding
- We are evolving as an organisation with an improved approach to Membership engagement
- We can help find another Lodge that may better suits their needs if they wish.





5.6

OUR AUDIENCES

External audiences
The Media
Potential members
Subscribing members
Unattached members
Paid staff in Masonic buildings (UGLE, Provinces and Halls)
Masonic Families

UNITED GRAND LODGE OF ENGLAND

PAID STAFF IN MASONIC BUILDINGS (UGLE, Provinces AND Halls)

Who are they?

These are staff members that work for UGLE, Provinces or in a Masonic Hall, but are not Freemasons.

What do they care about?

- They are passionate about their roles
- Are often asked about Freemasonry by members of the public (and their family).

SO!

We must demonstrate:

- That we can provide a thorough overview of what Freemasonry is – as well as answers to difficult questions on a number of topics
- How their roles are a key to successful centres and happy members.





5.7

OUR AUDIENCES

External audiences
The Media
Potential members
Subscribing members
Unattached members
Paid staff in Masonic buildings (UGLE, Provinces and Halls)
Masonic Families

UNITED GRAND LODGE OF ENGLAND

MASONIC FAMILIES

Who are they?

These are families of Freemasons and in some cases, widow of members.

What do they care about?

- They are often keen to preserve the legacy of their relative if their connection to Freemasonry has died
- They may want to understand what are the items in a family members 'case'
- They are keen to be supportive of their family member, although it is likely that their own, individual knowledge of Freemasonry isn't strong.

SO!

We must demonstrate:

- That as an organisation, we encourage Lodges to support masonic widows and to maintain contact even after the death of their loved one
- That we are an open organisation that is keen to engage and share information about who we are and what we do
- That many centres and Freemasons' Hall in London are open to the public to come and visit.





6.1

BRAND CHECKLIST

Before you start creating any form of content, it's important to check the following:

UNITED GRAND LODGE OF ENGLAND

1 WHO ARE YOU TALKING TO?

- Who is your audience?
- What do they care about?
- What are your main three messages?
- What channel will you use?
- What tone will you use?
- What photography will enhance your message?

2 WHAT WILL MAKE IT ENGAGING?

- How do we grab their attention?
- How do we ensure they read it all?
- Can we break it down into short sections?
- What will get them to care?
- What images will enhance the content?
- How can we make sure that the enjoyment and sociability of Freemasonry is communicated effectively?

3 WHY ARE WE TALKING TO THEM?

- What are we sharing?
- Can it be shared through other channels?
- What are the relevant points they need to know?
- How will this content address these points?
- How can we make it clear and engaging?

4 WHAT DO WE WANT THEM TO DO?

- What is the call to action?
- Is there a follow-up message planned?
- Can the content be used for other audiences or channels?

Do you have to believe in a God?

When becoming a Freemason, members are expected to be able to affirm a belief in a 'Supreme Being'. This is deliberately phrased so as to be fully inclusive and we celebrate the diverse nature of the beliefs of our members. There is no requirement to be an active practitioner of any particular religion.

Historical Suspicion: Freemasonry has long been viewed with scepticism, particularly by authoritarian regimes and religious institutions. During the 18th and 19th centuries, conspiracy theories about Freemasons secretly wielding power or influencing political events became widespread, perpetuating suspicions.

Cultural Portrayals: Popular culture frequently depicts Freemasons as a shadowy organisation with hidden agendas. Books, films, comics, and television often exaggerate or invent their practices, further cementing this perception.

Misinterpretation of Privacy: Freemasonry places a strong emphasis on privacy rather than secrecy. Members argue that their traditions are private to preserve meaning within the organisation, not to deliberately exclude or conceal from the public.

Lack of Public Understanding:
Despite efforts in recent years to promote transparency—such as opening lodges for public tours and highlighting their charitable work—Freemasonry remains poorly understood. Increased awareness and understanding of what Freemasonry actually is, is getting better, but will take time and patience and requires the dedication of members to speak in a clear and honest way about what their membership is and not perpetuation of cliché misconceptions. Masonic venues are often open for public tours, masons attending events and copies of the ceremony books available for purchase on well known online stores.

Together, the interplay of historical mistrust, cultural misrepresentation, and a lack of understanding perpetuates the enduring notion of Freemasonry as a secretive, male only, organisation–overtime these misunderstanding are being addressed.



ATTRACT

Attracting Members

- Expectation Management from the first point of contact



An essential part of the membership process is matching potential candidates to a suitable Lodge, this can mean on occasion introducing a friend to a Lodge where you are not a member – simply because it meets at a better location, time of the week for them and means there is a greater chance they will remain a member (remember that doesn't stop you visiting that Lodge if they join).

At this early stage in someone's journey when enquiring about freemasonry there is the opportunity to set expectations and highlight ***One Journey One Organisation***, remember someone who is not a member may never have heard about the Royal Arch but by explaining that when you join "***you take three ceremonies in your Lodge and a fourth in a Royal Arch Chapter at a time of your choosing***" ***you help give some context and lay the foundations of what they may expect***.

Every Lodge has different characteristics and it is crucial for a Lodge to understand what they represent, what they find important and what they want to achieve for the future so that they can match the potential candidate's expectations with what the Lodge has to offer. While it may go against the grain, it is better to find a more appropriate other Lodge than to draw in a potential member and risk losing him because their expectations cannot, for whatever reason, be met.

An easy way to understand this is to create a Lodge Information Sheet. This could even take the form of a promotional leaflet and be used by the members when interacting with potential new members and explaining more about the Lodge.

In summary, the Lodge Outline is an honest self-assessment of the Lodge intended for internal use. The Lodge Information Sheet is based on the Lodge Outline but is written for those who are not Freemasons, in everyday language, and is used to promote and explain the details of your Lodge.

Please liaise with your Provincial Membership Team as they may well have a preferred template for such information or be able to give you guidance.

Thread Link: Expectation management from the first point of contact





ATTRACT

Interview Prospective Members

Managing Enquiries

Direct Enquiries (*formerly known as Sponsored Candidates*) are those already known to a Lodge member (often seen as the traditional route); **Independent Enquiries** (*formerly known as unsponsored candidates*) are those who generally enquire through social media or websites, etc.

It is essential for both is that a Lodge Membership Team has a process in place on how to manage the enquiry.

Provincial Membership Teams will have a process in place for **Independent Enquiries** (*an example of which is shown in the support material for this thread*) prior to introduction to a suitable Lodge. But for **Direct Enquiries** this process is led and managed by your team completely.

The graphic opposite gives some visual prompts as to key points to consider when engaging with a **Direct** or **Independent Enquiry** however, detailed guidance can be found in the thread using the link at the end of this page.

Good practice suggests:

- Set up a Lodge Screening Panel (a couple of members)
- Meet the candidate at a neutral venue
- Discuss expectations ▶both their's and the Lodge's
- Additional meetings ▶ gather more information/ get to know them
- Introduction to Lodge members – after the LOI or at a social event (including online events)
- Invite them to social events – ladies' night etc
- Discuss the timeline regarding becoming a member
- Discuss cost and fees (a chance to use your **Lodge Information Sheet**).

Thread Link: Members Enquiry Management

CLICK PDF icon to download the support material

One Approach to Independent Enquiries

ONE APPROACH TO INDEPENDENT ENQUIRIES

Yorkshire and West Riding

The Province of Yorkshire and West Riding has an established **process for management of Independent Enquiries** (*formerly known as Unsponsored Candidates*). This process has evolved through trial and error, but improves through review and the drive to enhance the experience for everyone involved.

The process requires a commitment:-

Provincial Membership team
Promote and oversee the whole project, facilitating the training and supporting of Area Teams and Lodges.

Provincial Enquiry Management Team
Process the Independent Enquiries, and conduct the first calls/engagement with the person enquiring.

Commitment from Area Membership Officers
Conduct the second screening calls / in-person meetings, support enquiries, liaise with Lodge Membership Teams, and may attend Initiations as a friendly face.

Buy-in from Lodges
Provide Lodge Outlines and Information Sheets (without these, Independent Enquiries not allocated to a Lodge), engage with prospective Candidates, and give feedback to the Provincial Membership Team.

Support from the Province with IT
Provide resources and technical support (delivered by members with the skills, who have developed and manage the CRM database for enquiries)

Provincial Communications team
In liaison with the Membership Team, have developed a suite of physical and virtual resources that can be used to promote Freemasonry and channel all enquiries through the Provincial website form.

LEVEL 3: UNIT RESOURCES

Attract > Interview Prospective Members > *Enquiry Management*

Independent Enquiries [support material]

Case Study: Yorkshire and West Riding

Training Members to be Proud	Ensuring the Membership Challenge is understood by Lodges	That members are able to speak with Pride about their membership		
Securing Buy-in from Provincial Team, Area Reps and Lodges	Ensure all parties are willing to follow the process and provide information when needed.	Remind Lodge Membership Teams Independent Candidates are only on source and this should not stop Lodges seeking to find their own (Direct) Candidates.		
Promotional Materials	Developed online Enq Form	Posters for Masonic Halls open to public with QR Codes to register interest in joining	Pull Up Banners for Events with 'attraction' message and QR Code	Targeted digital marketing campaigns
Website Form	Registering Enquiry details in a clear way	Captures key details of the individual including email and phone number		
Added to CRM	Enq checked by Provincial Membership Team and added to CRM	Automatic email and SMS sent to the enquirer to say member of Membership Team will be in contact within 48 hours and the email may have gone in SPAM	Enquiry Allocated to a Member of the Provincial Team to conduct the initial screening	
Initial Screening	Done by trained member of the Provincial Membership Team	Looks to secure answers to all key questions but also learn more about the individual to gain information which could assist with allocation to a masonic centre	All information shared is recorded against the enquirer's profile so infomation is there for others to refer to	

Allocation to Group / Area Membership Officer	Initial contact by phone that is than followed up in person	Meet to discuss interests, motivations	Use Lodge Outlines to match the enquirer	Share Lodge Information sheets to the enquirer to help them make and informed decision on whom they would like to speak to
Introduced to suitable Lodge	Introduction to suitable Lodge facilitated by Area / Group Membership Officer	The Provincial Team 'hands over to the Lodge Membership Team' but remains in contact with the enquirer to provide support if needed		
Lodge Membership Team	Informally meet with the enquirer and screen to ensure they are a fit for the enquirer and the enquirer is s fit for them	**If all positive proceed to interview** - any issues refer back Group / Area Membership Officer (either way keep them updated)		
Lodge Interview / Introduced alternative Lodge	When an the enquirer reaches this stage an interview may seem like *over kill* but is a final chance to ensure each party is happy.	The interview should be conducted using the good practice in Building Together> Attract>Interview Prospective Members>the Interview	Should there be any questions or concerns assistance should be sought from the Provincial Team	**The Outcome of the interview and date for Initiation should be communicated to the Provincial Membership Team**
Expectation Management	If it has been a while since the Lodge has had a candidate time should be spent reminding members of Good Practice in supporting the candidate	For the Candidate (no longer the enquirer) they will need support on what they should expect	Candidates will be interested in attending social events	
Initiation	ensure the Provincial Team is updated of when the meeting is	update the Provincial team when the Initiation has happened / of any issues		



LEVEL 3: UNIT RESOURCES

Attract > Interview Prospective Members > *Enquiry Management*

Independent Enquiries [support material]

Case Study: Yorkshire and West Riding

ATTRACT

Interview Prospective Members

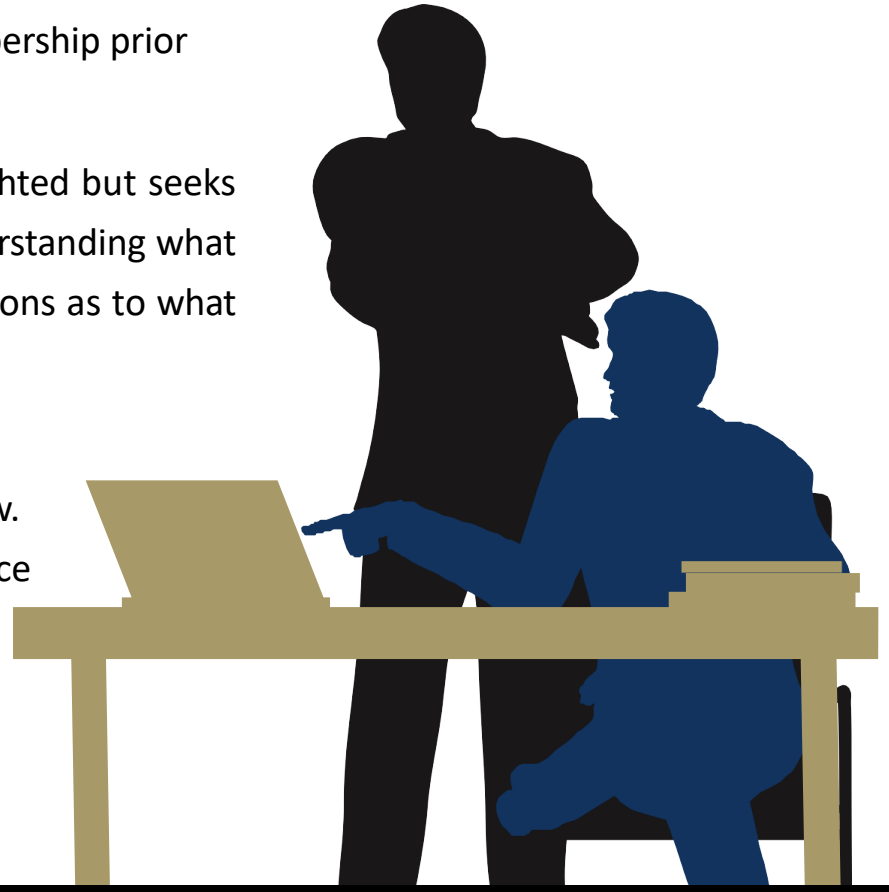
Screening Process

Screening is quite simply a single conversation or perhaps a series of informal conversations with the person enquiring about membership prior to the Lodge Interview.

This re-enforces the expectation management already highlighted but seeks to ensure that the person looking to become a member understanding what Freemasonry is about, re-set any of the common misconceptions as to what freemasonry is by using examples from your own experiences.

Guidance on what you might discuss and how to shape this conversation can be found in detail by visiting the thread below. In addition to the support material which gives specific guidance and additional resources that may prove useful.

Thread Link: Screening



CLICK PDF icon to download the support material

- Techniques for Screening Prospective Candidates
- Aims and Relationships of the Craft
- Summary of the Antient Charges and Regulations
- Information Required for Screening
- Suggested Reading List



ATTRACT

Interview Prospective Members

The Interview

It is recommended that the **interview is conducted by three Lodge members to create a positive experience** for the applicant. Ideally, at least one of the interviewers should know the candidate or have met him during the Enquiry Management phase, and is therefore seen as a friendly face.

Preparation for Interview:

- Informal meetings
- Be open, honest, clear and direct about the commitment involved in becoming a Freemason
- Answer any questions and if you don't know the answers say so, find out and go back to the applicant
- Explain the process – interview, proposal, ballot, initiation and potential timescales
- Set date for interview.

Interview:

- No more than three to four members of the Lodge to deliver a friendly environment
- Structured process
- Use example questions with skill and discretion
- Communicate the outcome in a timely manner.

If enquiry management and preparation for the interview have been conducted properly, the actual interview should not hold any surprises.

Specific Guidance on how to conduct the interview, invite the candidate for their interview, examples of questions, guidance on interview techniques plus guidance on how to make a decision and communicate the outcome to the candidate can be found below in the thread and support material:

Thread Link: **The Interview**

CLICK PDF icon to download the support material

- Template Letters to Applicants
- Examples of Interview Questions
- Techniques for Interviewing Applicants
- Deciding and Communicating Interview Outcomes





ATTRACT

Interview Prospective Members

Expectation Management

The candidate will form a lasting impression of Freemasonry based on his early experiences (both positive and negative!) and the expectations of the candidate and those of the Lodge members need to be carefully managed and aligned.

The preparation for the initiation should not be a rushed process as there is a balance between the needs of the candidate and the Lodge's programme of work.

When briefing the candidate for his initiation, strike a balance between telling him enough so that he is prepared and not telling him too much, which can spoil the occasion.

Some points to consider are shown in summary in the graphic opposite however a detailed summary with guidance can be found in the full thread and support materials listed below:

Condider the following for the candidate:

- Arrange a lift to and from the meeting
- Introductions – WM, JD and Tyler
- Ensure he has a bottle of water as he waits for the ceremony
- Sit him with a member after the ceremony
- Have some cash for him for charity collections etc
- Introduce him to members after the meeting
- Explain the toasts
- Maintain contact after the meeting
- Introduce to LOI
- Ensure someone hosts him at his first full meeting and explains what is happening.

Thread Link: Expectation Management

CLICK PDF icon to download the support material

PDF Scheduling the date of Initiation

PDF Briefing the Candidate for Initiation



CONTINUE

- After the break, we will look at the Continue Hub – sessions restart at 14:30



CONTINUE

Attracting Future Companions

Promoting your Chapter

The Continue Hub, focuses on how a Royal Arch Chapter can ensure they have the correct resources to promote their Chapter and how each Companion can be empowered to speak with knowledge and confidence of what it means for them to me a member of The Royal Arch.

- When promoting your Chapter you are speaking to an audience of Master Masons. In contrast to when someone is at the start of their journey you will be speaking to Brethren who can understand and appreciate some aspects of masonic culture and practice.
- Developing a Chapter Information Sheet which can be used by prospective candidates is key to ensuring future members are able to make an informed decision on what day of the week, time, location, cost and frequency of when their Chapter may meet. Matching a Master Mason to a Royal Arch Chapter which is not a good fit for their pre-existing commitments, could in the long term, prove detrimental to their membership of the Royal Arch.
- In addition to developing your Information sheet, the talking heads presentation and discover more booklet are resources which you will find useful.

By reading the thread and support material you will be better placed to understand the steps Companions and the Chapter Membership Team will need to take to support Master Masons in their Journey to be Companions and maintaining their engagement;



Thread Link: **Promoting your Chapter**

CLICK PDF icon to download the support material

Chapter Description

Using Discover More

Using Talking Heads

TALKING HEADS – A presentation for use in Lodges



CONTINUE

Attracting Future Companions

- All Companions are RA Champions

All Companions have the opportunity to be Royal Arch ambassadors. Ensuring that we highlight the fun and enjoyment which is derived from membership of the Royal Arch is a key way to encourage Master Masons to look to continue their journey.

Companions have already developed a series of valuable materials, listed in this Thread as support materials, which can be vital in helping members explain what the Royal Arch is. Taking the skills you have developed in your Lodge, build your statement as to 'what benefits/ pleasure you get from being a member of your lodge, now look at how you can use similar language to explain to Brethren about Royal Arch Chapters.

Why Join & Discover More are two functional support materials, and no matter how experienced a Companion you are, utilising the resources in the Engage Hub, which relate to further learning and mentoring about the Royal Arch (including the Welcome Companion Booklet), will ensure the basis of your knowledge is enhanced.

Knowing what not to say is also essential. Phrases and descriptions that may have once been told to you or you may have overheard could be wrong, but it has become customary to use them. The support material, ***What not to say***, provides companions with a useful resource to ensure they can act as informed Companions.

On this occasion, the text in the extended thread matches what is written here, BUT these SUPPORT MATERIALS are essential reading:

Thread Link: **All Companions are RA Champions**

CLICK PDF icon to download the support material

PDF Using Discover More

PDF Why Join

PDF What not to say



CONTINUE

Attracting Future Companions

Royal Arch Reps

Not all Provinces have Royal Arch Representatives, some use different titles such as Royal Arch Liaison Officers and many other variations. For the purpose of Building Together we have used the term Royal Arch Rep as this is most commonly understood.

- **A non-collared office in a Lodge, the Royal Arch Rep is the Lodge's Champion of the Royal Arch**, this does not exclude any other Companion advocating the Royal Arch as ***all Companions should be Royal Arch Champions***.
- **The Royal Arch Rep should work in conjunction with the Lodge Mentor and personal mentors of EAs, FCs and MMs** to help give context to the Royal Arch and support the Lodge mentoring team in signposting suitable Royal Arch Chapters which meet in locations, dates and times that would meet the needs of the Brother.

No Brother should be influenced to join a Chapter which does not meet their needs simply because this is a Chapter associated with the Lodge, it is important the meeting schedule meets the Brother / Future Companions needs otherwise we create the first step on the journey to future dissatisfaction.

A full review of ways in which a Royal Arch Representative can contribute and resources available can be found in the full thread together with a suite of support materials.

Thread Link: **Royal Arch Reps**

CLICK PDF icon to download the support material

PDF **Using Talking Heads**



CONTINUE

Attracting Future Companions

Where Prospective Companions Come From

Prospective Companions can only come from Lodges and invariably Lodges that are successful in generating new members through well managed attraction events and a programme of good mentoring and support will be those who provide engaged Master Masons keen to continue their journey.

Traditionally many Companions join their Royal Arch Chapter owing to a link it may have with the Lodge of which they are a member. It was not so much an evaluated choice for the Brother as to which Chapter they join, but a well-established path trodden by other members. This type of journey is perhaps most common where the Lodge and Chapter share the same name.

Feeder Lodges can fit the description to the left, however in some Provinces some Royal Arch Chapters have sought to take the good practice from Archway (or adapt the Members' Pathway ideas) and look to engage with all of the brethren of all of the Lodges that meet at their Centre / City ensuring Brethren have an awareness of that Chapter for when they look to continue their journey.

Provincial Royal Arch Promotion Events—Many Provinces are using the One Journey, One Organisation approach to stage Provincial (sometimes broken down to area depending on the province's size) events to engage with Brethren eligible to join the Royal Arch and unattached Companions.

These events rarely promote a specific Chapter but look to inspire Master Masons to continue their journey. Then, based on their desired days of the week to meet, locations, frequency, and budget, a suitable chapter can be identified, and an introduction made.

The text above duplicates the full thread and should you wish to read as a PDF you can do so here:

Thread Link: Where Prospective Companions Come From





CONTINUE

Screening Prospective Companions

The Right Chapter

Continuing your journey as a Freemason and joining a Chapter is seen by many as a logical progression on your journey of learning and discovery.

Unfortunately, errors by well-meaning Royal Arch Representatives confusing encouragement with pressuring may have blinkered some individuals' perception of the Royal Arch.

This can be further compounded by the reality that owing to absence of mentoring as a new Companion they fail to understand the significance of symbolism they have experienced within the ceremony.

These are not traits unique to the Royal Arch, some Lodges have experienced issues with the production line of initiates who leave quickly owing to lack of support; on rare occasions some members respond well to the sink or swim approach and develop their own route to access support and guidance but this is rare!

Successful Lodges provide Brethren with an engaging programme of events supported by mentoring, which means that those looking to join a Royal Arch Chapter invariably will expect similar engagement and support once they become Companions.

Just as Lodges are encouraged to screen prospective candidates, Royal Arch Chapters are encouraged to ensure that:

1. Is the Prospective Companion right for their Chapter?
2. Is the Chapter right for the Prospective Companion?

If either is in doubt, other Chapters should be considered.

Thread Link: **The Right Chapter**



CONTINUE

Screening Prospective Companions

Commitment

There are a number of differences between Craft and Chapter membership, all of which have associated financial commitments, from the frequency of meetings to the increased up-front costs associated with joining.

Time should be spent with Prospective Companions as part of the screening process, ensuring that, not only are they not overcommitting financially,but that they have:-

- Time for an additional commitment
- Bandwidth in terms of commitment to learning new ritual, this can be an opportunity to informally introduce the various offices in the Royal Arch and discuss their desire to progress once a member. This interest should be balanced against their Work, Family and Craft commitments to ensure the Prospective Companion isn't overcommitting.

This discussion on commitment should be friendly and informal, using examples relating to the Brothers' experiences in their Lodge so they can easily understand and appreciate.

As highlighted in other material, using the Chapters' Information Sheet and Discover More can be helpful resources for this discussion.

This text duplicates the full thread a PDF copy you can find here:

Commitment



CONTINUE

Expectation Management

Meetings / Festive Boards

A Prospective Companion looking to join the Royal Arch only has their experience gained in their Lodge. It is likely they only have one Craft Membership at the time they are looking to Continue their journey of discovery and as such they have little to base their expectations on.

The Chapter's Information Sheet is a key resource when explaining to Prospective Companions;-

- **Meeting Frequencies** – both actual meetings and rehearsals (invariably Royal Arch Chapters meet on much reduced frequency compared to Lodges)
- **Costs,** both in subscriptions and purchase of regalia
- **Difference in Vocabulary and Officers,** it may prove beneficial to explain who some of the KEY ROYAL ARCH OFFICERS are and compare them to roles that they will understand from the Lodge ie: ScribeE is the Secretary etc.
- **The Number of Ceremonies**
- **The Discover More Booklet** and **Why Join** support material can be a helpful basis for discussion.

This text duplicates the full thread a PDF copy you can find here:

Meetings and Festive Boards



CONTINUE

Expectation Management

Regalia

For a Prospective Companion joining the Royal Arch is hopefully an experience that they are looking forward to, some candidates however can be surprised at the associated upfront costs:

The upfront costs of purchasing regalia may be a surprise – especially with how different the regalia and jewel is to what is worn in Lodge.

The candidate's sponsor, Chapter Membership Officer, Lodge Royal Arch Rep and / or the Brothers Lodge / Personal Mentor can all play a role in setting expectations about regalia

- Ensuring the candidate understands that this will be what they wear until they go into the "equivalent of the WM's Chair" as such they will get good few years wear.

- Signposting options for where they can buy the regalia, ensuring they buy the right items. (This signposting may also include the option of Pre-Loved Regalia if the Province runs such a scheme, and the member would be interested in that option.

- They should also remind the Prospective Companion that when they come to the meeting where they join, in addition to bringing their new Royal Arch Regalia, they should bring a Master Mason's Apron.

- **This text duplicates the full thread a PDF copy you can find here:**